

Melanie De Luna

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Biology student with direct experience in surgical pathology, clinical diagnostics, and molecular biology research within regulated, high-volume laboratory environments. Proficient in gross examination, specimen processing, high-throughput clinical instrumentation, and a broad range of microbiological and molecular techniques. Seeking a pathology or clinical laboratory role within a hospital or health system where hands-on technical training and attention to regulatory compliance add immediate value.

EDUCATION

Texas A&M University-San Antonio

Bachelor of Science in Biology | Concentration: Cell and Molecular Biology

Cumulative GPA: 3.57/4.00 | Dean's List: Fall 2022, Fall 2023

Relevant Coursework: Molecular Biology, Bacteriology, Genetics, Cell Biology, Organic Chemistry I & II, Microbiology

San Antonio, TX

Expected May 2027

WORK EXPERIENCE

Labcorp Center for Disease Detection

Lab Assistant Intern

San Antonio, TX

Jun 2026 – Aug 2026

- Cross-trained in Immunology, Molecular Microbiology, Hematology, Serology, Histology, and Cytology within a high-volume clinical diagnostic lab processing approximately 10,000 patient specimens daily.
- Supported diagnostic testing workflow for HIV, hepatitis, syphilis, *Chlamydia trachomatis*, *Neisseria gonorrhoeae*, HPV, and vaginitis-associated pathogens.
- Assisted with operation of high-throughput clinical analyzers by loading reagents, troubleshooting routine instrument alerts, and supporting daily laboratory workflow.
- Engaged medical technologists and laboratory supervisors with targeted questions to build understanding of clinical rationale, testing protocols, and departmental operations across multiple specialty areas.

Pathology Reference Laboratory

Grossing Technician

San Antonio, TX

Aug 2025 – Jun 2026

- Received, identified, and processed fresh and fixed human tissue specimens while maintaining specimen integrity and regulatory compliance.
- Performed gross examination of biopsies and surgical specimens and supported pathology operations through accessioning, cassette preparation, and tissue processing.

Sally Beauty

Certified Keyholder

San Antonio, TX

Jan 2024 – Aug 2025

- Trusted with keyholder responsibilities, including opening/closing operations, securing store assets, and managing daily safety protocols.
- Provided personalized customer service and product recommendations to meet customer needs.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Bacterial Genomics Research Project

- Analyzed and interpreted bacterial DNA sequence data using NCBI BLAST and KBase to identify bacterial isolates and characterize genomic features.
- Investigated genes and biosynthetic pathways associated with antibiotic production as part of a faculty-led research project examining the effects of land development on soil microbial communities.

Tiny Earth Research Project

- Isolated and cultured bacteria from soil samples using aseptic technique, serial dilutions, and streak plating to obtain pure bacterial colonies.
- Screened bacterial isolates for antimicrobial activity against *Bacillus* tester strains and identified potential antibiotic-producing bacteria through laboratory assays and DNA sequence analysis.

TECHNICAL & LABORATORY SKILLS

Laboratory Techniques: Aseptic Technique, Laboratory Media & Agar Preparation, Pipetting, Light Microscopy, PCR, Gel Electrophoresis, DNA Sequence Analysis, Specimen Handling, Grossing, DNA Extraction

Clinical Instrumentation: Abbott Alinity i, Roche cobas® 6800 System, Sakura Tissue-Tek® VIP A120 Tissue Processor, Hologic ThinPrep Genesis Processor

Software & Bioinformatics: Microsoft Excel, Microsoft Word, Microsoft PowerPoint, NCBI BLAST, KBase